

FIX: Remove Earnings Trade Block, Replace With Alert

PROBLEM: The Strategist currently blocks all trade recommendations when earnings fall within the DTE window. This was a policy choice that is not working in practice. During earnings season, it blocks nearly every major ticker and produces no actionable output. The Strategist's job is to recommend trades, not refuse to operate for weeks at a time.

CHANGE 1: REMOVE EARNINGS BLOCK FROM STRIKE RESOLUTION In the strike resolution pipeline (Step 1, Expiration Selection), remove the rule that rejects expirations crossing an earnings event. Earnings should NOT be a blocking gate. The system should resolve strikes and recommend trades regardless of whether earnings falls within the DTE window.

CHANGE 2: ADD EARNINGS WARNING TO OUTPUT If an earnings event falls between now and the selected expiration, add a prominent warning to the output instead of blocking:

In the resolved trade output object, add to the warnings array:

- "EARNINGS: [TICKER] reports earnings on [DATE] ([BEFORE_OPEN or AFTER_CLOSE]). This position expires after earnings. Expect elevated IV and potential gap risk."

In the Strategist UI, display this warning in a yellow/orange banner on the recommendation card (not red, red is for errors). Make it clearly visible but not alarming.

In the AI narrative, Claude should mention the earnings date and note that the position will be held through the event, so the user is aware of the added volatility risk.

CHANGE 3: ADD EARNINGS ALERT FOR OPEN POSITIONS This is a separate but related feature. When the user has open options positions, the system should check if any of those positions have earnings coming up and alert them.

On the Portfolio page, if any open options position has an underlying with earnings within the next 5 trading days:

- Show a yellow alert badge on that position
- Display: "[TICKER] earnings [DATE] [BEFORE_OPEN/AFTER_CLOSE]. You have open options expiring [EXPIRATION]. Review position."

This is informational only. It does not suggest closing or adjusting. It just makes sure the user knows earnings is coming for something they are holding.

CHANGE 4: MAX CONTRACTS FLOOR While in this area of the code: Max Contracts is still showing 0 on Strategist output. This was supposed to be fixed. The floor is 1 contract, always. If the sizing formula outputs 0, set it to 1 and add a warning about position size exceeding risk limits. Zero is never a valid output when the engine is recommending a trade.

DO NOT remove earnings dates from the Strategist display. The earnings event tags (e.g. "Microsoft Earnings 2026-04-23") should still appear on both Scanner results and Strategist output. They are useful context. They just should not block trades.

SUCCESS CRITERIA:

1. AMZN with earnings on May 7 should produce a full trade recommendation with resolved strikes, not a "STRIKE RESOLUTION FAILED" message.
2. The recommendation should include a visible earnings warning banner.
3. Max Contracts is never 0. Minimum is 1.
4. Open positions on the Portfolio page show earnings alerts when applicable.